

Monday, 31 August 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Showers

22° 15°

BIRMINGHAM

Drizzle

18° 14°

MANCHESTER

Light drizzle

18° 14°

GLASGOW

Overcast

18° 14°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1

The Prime Minister has announced changes to the early release scheme, meaning killers like those of PC Harper will stay in jail.

Anyone convicted of manslaughter will now be excluded from the early release scheme under the Sentencing Act. This follows pressure from campaigners and politicians to keep serious offenders behind bars for longer.

CRIME · UK

2

A British woman has tragically been killed in a stabbing incident at a railway station in Germany.

The 27-year-old victim was attacked in Rosenheim, Bavaria. A 27-year-old German man was arrested immediately after the incident.

TRAGEDY · INTERNATIONAL

3

Two people are currently missing after a French fishing boat sank in the busy English Channel.

Three of the five crew members on board were successfully rescued and have been taken to hospital. Coastguard teams are continuing their search for the missing individuals.

INCIDENT · UK

4

Police are continuing to question one man following a fatal fire that claimed the lives of a seven-year-old girl and her aunt.

One of the two initial suspects has now been released. Officers are still working to establish the full circumstances surrounding the blaze.

CRIME · UK

5

A third murder charge has been brought in connection with the fatal stabbing outside Brent Council HQ.

17-year-old David Wynter died after being attacked on Engineers Way, near the Civic Centre. Police are continuing their investigation into the incident.

CRIME · UK

What's coming up

- 1 British singer Charli XCX brought an electrifying performance to Reading Festival over the weekend.**
 She headlined the first night, delivering an era-spanning set that delighted fans. Irish rock band Fontaines DC also topped the bill on Friday night.

ON AIR – Did you make it to Reading or Leeds Festival this year? Which acts were you most excited to see?

MUSIC · WHEN
- 2 Paul Heaton has scored his first number one album, while a classic Dolly Parton track has finally entered the UK Top 40.**
 Heaton's latest solo album has topped the charts. Meanwhile, Parton's iconic 1980 US hit '9 to 5' has, at last, reached the UK top 40.

ON AIR – What's your favourite Paul Heaton song? Or is '9 to 5' a tune you're glad to hear on the chart?

MUSIC · THIS WEEK
- 3 Fans and critics alike are buzzing after an official preview of the highly anticipated video game Grand Theft Auto 6.**
 The blockbuster title gave an official look at what's to come, leaving many impressed. Expectations are now sky-high for its eventual release.

ON AIR – Are you a fan of the Grand Theft Auto series? What are you hoping to see in the new game?

GAMING · COMING SOON
- 4 British wrestler Will Ospreay is set to headline AEW's major 'All In' show at London's Wembley Stadium this weekend.**
 Known as the 'aerial assassin', Ospreay has overcome a serious injury to reach this career highlight. It's a huge moment for British wrestling on the global stage.

ON AIR – Are you heading to Wembley for All In? Who are you most excited to see in action?

WRESTLING · THIS WEEK
- 5 Actor Jacob Elordi has spoken about how Sir Ridley Scott's new post-apocalyptic epic, 'The Dog Stars', made him reflect on life.**
 The film explores themes of hope in a world ravaged by a pandemic. Elordi admitted the role prompted him to ask 'What am I missing' in his own life?

ON AIR – Do films ever make you think deeply about your own life? Which ones have had that effect?

FILM · COMING SOON

On the schedule

1 **England have delivered a clinical performance to secure a series win over Pakistan in the second Test at Lord's.**

They steamrolled Pakistan on the fourth day, closing out the match convincingly. This victory seals the series with a match to spare.

ON AIR – Another dominant performance from England! What's been the key to their success in this series?

CRICKET · UK

2 **Chelsea secured a thrilling 4-3 victory over Brighton, but questions remain about their defensive vulnerabilities.**

New goalkeeper Emiliano Martinez made his debut, but even he couldn't entirely solve the club's issues at the back. Despite the win, manager Mauricio Pochettino will be keen to tighten things up.

ON AIR – Chelsea got the win, but are you concerned about their defence? Can they challenge for the title with these issues?

FOOTBALL · UK

3 **Manchester United secured a Premier League win against Ipswich, with Bruno Fernandes putting in a perfect performance.**

United's captain was instrumental in their victory. The team will be looking to build on this result as the season progresses.

ON AIR – How impressed were you with Bruno Fernandes' performance? Is he the key to United's success this season?

FOOTBALL · UK

4 **Ollie Watkins has completed a significant £51 million move from Aston Villa to Saudi Pro League side Al-Hilal.**

The England international striker's transfer marks another high-profile departure from the Premier League. He'll be joining a growing list of stars in Saudi Arabia.

ON AIR – What do you make of top Premier League players moving to the Saudi League? Is it good for the game?

FOOTBALL · UK

5 **Former supermarket delivery driver Joe Dean has stormed to victory, winning his first DP World Tour title at the British Masters.**

Dean fired a stunning nine-under-par final round to come from seven shots back. It's an incredible story of perseverance and talent.

ON AIR – What an inspiring story! Do you love seeing an underdog triumph in sport?

GOLF · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A new trend sees people transforming garden sheds into 'reading nooks' and 'hobby hubs', creating a delightful escape at home.**
These once-humble garden buildings are being decked out with comfy chairs, bookshelves, and craft tables, offering a peaceful sanctuary for hobbies away from the main house.
- 2 The delightful art of 'picnic planning' is having a resurgence, with people rediscovering the simple joy of al fresco dining.**
From elaborate hampers to simple sandwiches in a scenic spot, enjoying a meal outdoors with loved ones is proving to be a popular way to spend a sunny afternoon.
- 3 More people are embracing 'mindful walking' in local parks, focusing on the sights and sounds around them to boost well-being.**
This gentle practice encourages individuals to slow down, pay attention to nature, and enjoy the present moment, rather than rushing through their stroll.
- 4 The charming tradition of 'leaving painted rocks' in public places for others to find and re-hide is bringing unexpected joy to communities.**
These colourful, often uplifting rocks, hidden in parks and along pathways, create a lovely treasure hunt for all ages and spread a little cheer.
- 5 A growing number of individuals are finding calm by 'learning to identify different bird songs' in their gardens and local areas.**
Tuning into the natural soundscape helps people connect with nature and provides a relaxing, educational hobby that can be enjoyed from home.
- 6 The humble 'doorstep delivery' is experiencing a nostalgic revival, with local bakers and milkmen seeing a surge in popularity.**
Many are rediscovering the convenience and charm of having fresh produce and daily essentials delivered right to their door, supporting local businesses in the process.
- 7 Creating a 'memory jar' is becoming a sweet way for families to record happy moments throughout the year.**
Little notes detailing joyful events or funny anecdotes are popped into a jar, to be opened and read together at the end of the year, bringing back wonderful memories.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to quickly judge if a new brand of coffee will be good, without actually tasting it first?

ANSWER: SMELLING THE BEANS OR GROUNDS RIGHT FROM THE PACKET, HOPING FOR A RICH AROMA.

Q Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a good book, especially if it's a new one. What is it?

ANSWER: GENTLY SMOOTHING DOWN ALL THE PAGES, OR TAPPING THE SPINE LIGHTLY.

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes a particular 'smell' can instantly transport you back to a specific memory or a moment from your past?

What's a scent that brings back a really vivid memory for you, and what's the story behind it?

- We all have those 'unusual little things' we collect or keep hold of, not for their monetary value, but purely for sentimental reasons, don't we?

What's the most unusual or surprising thing you collect, or a quirky sentimental item you just can't part with?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** A group of owls is called a 'parliament'.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Butterflies taste with their antennae.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£5.2 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£5.2 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- Big Ben is actually the nickname for the Great Bell of the clock at the north end of the Palace of Westminster in London, not the clock tower itself.
- The longest recorded flight of a chicken is 13 seconds.
- The first ever recorded 'snail race' took place in England in the 1960s.
- The inventor of the traffic light, Garrett Morgan, also invented the gas mask.
- Oxford University is older than the Aztec Empire.
- There are more permutations of a deck of 52 cards than there are atoms on Earth.
- The 'richest' bird's nest ever found was made entirely of paper money.
- Cats can make over 100 different sounds, while dogs can only make about 10.

On this day

Day 243 of the year, 122 days left in 2026. Today Baloch-Pakhtun Unity Day (Balochs and Pashtuns, International observance); Christian feast day: Aidan of Lindisfarne; Christian feast day: Aristides of Athens; Christian feast day: Cuthburh. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Peridot.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1971 — Kirstie Allsopp, British TV presenter
- 1979 — Yara Martinez, Puerto Rican-American actress
- 1998 — BossMan Dlow, American rapper
- 1967 — Gene Hoglan, American drummer
- 1960 — Chris Whitley, American singer-songwriter and guitarist (died 2005)
- 1962 — Dee Bradley Baker, American voice actor
- 1971 — Pádraig Harrington, Irish golfer
- 1977 — Ian Harte, Irish footballer

THE DAY TODAY

- 2025 — An earthquake in eastern Afghanistan kills over 1400 people.
- 1996 — Saddam Hussein's troops seize Irbil after the Kurdish Masoud Barzani appealed for help to defeat his Kurdish rival PUK.
- 1993 — Russia completes removing its troops from Lithuania.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1986 — Aeroméxico Flight 498 collides with a Piper PA-28 Cherokee over Cerritos, California, killing 67 in the air and 15 on the ground.
- 1994 — Russia completes removing its troops from Estonia.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1993 — Russia completes removing its troops from Lithuania.
- 1988 — Delta Air Lines Flight 1141 crashes during takeoff from Dallas/Fort Worth International Airport, killing 14.

- 2002 — Typhoon Rusa, the most powerful typhoon to hit South Korea in 43 years, makes landfall, killing at least 236 people.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 244 of the year, 121 days left in 2026. Today Feast of Creation (Christianity); Christian feast day: Constantius (Costanzo) of Aquino; Christian feast day: David Pendleton Oakerhater (Anglican Communion); Christian feast day: Giles. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1973 — Simon Shaw, English rugby player
- 1933 — Conway Twitty, American singer-songwriter and guitarist (died 1993)
- 1976 — Clare Connor, English cricketer
- 1991 — Rhys Bennett, English footballer
- 1957 — Gloria Estefan, Cuban-American singer-songwriter and actress
- 1996 — Zendaya, American actress and singer
- 1952 — Michael Masee, American actor (died 2016)
- 1984 — Joe Trohman, American singer-songwriter, guitarist and producer

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1864 — American Civil War: The Battle of Jonesborough, alongside the overall Atlanta campaign, culminates in a Union victory for General William T. Sherman as Confederate General John Bell Hood orders the evacuation of Atlanta.
- 1974 — The SR-71 Blackbird sets (and holds) the record for flying from New York to London in the time of one hour, 54 minutes and 56.4 seconds at a speed of 1,435.587 miles per hour (2,310.353 km/h).
- 1897 — The Tremont Street Subway in Boston opens, becoming the first underground rapid transit system in North America.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1880 — The army of Mohammad Ayub Khan is routed by the British at the Battle of Kandahar, ending the Second Anglo-Afghan War.
- 1873 — Cetshwayo ascends to the throne as king of the Zulu nation following the death of his father Mpande.

10 — FORWARD PLANNING • FILM

Coming to cinemas

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
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FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
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FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
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FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)
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OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
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FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)
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11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar